Isaac Stella

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Education

London School of Economics London, England
MSc Economics Degree Expected 2027
Dissertation Submitted September 2026
Coursework: Econometrics, Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Portfolio Management, Asset Markets.

McGill University Montréal, Quebec
B.A., First Class Joint Honours Economics and Political Science; Minor Computer Science June 2025
Coursework: Econometrics, Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Statistics, Probability, Algorithms & Data Structures.

Phillips Academy Andover, Massachusetts
High School Diploma, cum laude May 2020

Experience

McGill University Montréal, Quebec
Research Assistant June 2025 – September 2025

- Analysed financial data with R and Stata on Federal Reserve and ECB spillovers under Dr. Santiago Camara.
- Used SVAR model to disentangle pure monetary policy shocks from information effects.

McGill University Montréal, Quebec
Math Tutor May 2024 – August 2024

- Tutored eight students in linear algebra and multivariable calculus.
- Assisted each student in achieving a grade of A- or higher.

Papers and Projects

"Portfolio Management in a Low-Growth World: Repricing Profitability under Secular Stagnation" LSE Dissertation

- Built value, momentum, and Quality-Minus-Junk portfolios from raw CRSP/Compustat data (1.6M firm-months, 1990–2024) in R via WRDS; the value series tracks Fama–French HML at 0.90 correlation.
- Tested whether low r* and weak growth reprice durable profits: in five-factor regressions with regime interactions, value's profitability (RMW) loading flipped from +0.35 to −0.24 (t = −2.3).
- Traced the flip to profitable firms migrating into value's short leg (OP/BE tilt −0.27 to −0.39); momentum and quality controls plus a comovement/volatility decomposition ruled out alternatives.

"Brewing Change? The Effect of Maryland's 2011 State Alcohol Tax Increase on Violent Crime and Property Crime"

- Constructed a county-year panel from FBI UCR data (MD/PA, 2004–2015) and estimated a difference-in-differences model with two-way fixed effects to assess an alcohol tax's effect on crime.
- Diagnosed parallel-trends violations and confounding from macro shocks, demonstrating the limits of the causal design and proposing multi-control-state and higher-frequency-data extensions.

Skills & Interests

Skills: Excel/VBA, Microsoft Office, Python (pandas, NumPy, statsmodels, scikit-learn, PyTorch), R, SQL
Interests: Modern Chinese history, endogenous growth theory, literary modernism, jazz guitar, coffee